BROMIC
HEATING

RESIDENTIAL HOMEOWNER · ARCHITECT / DESIGNER · BUILDER / INSTALLER

Outdoor Living Trends 2026: ten shifts, and what to design for

Ten outdoor living trends for 2026, each with one sourced statistic and one design move for architects, builders and homeowners.

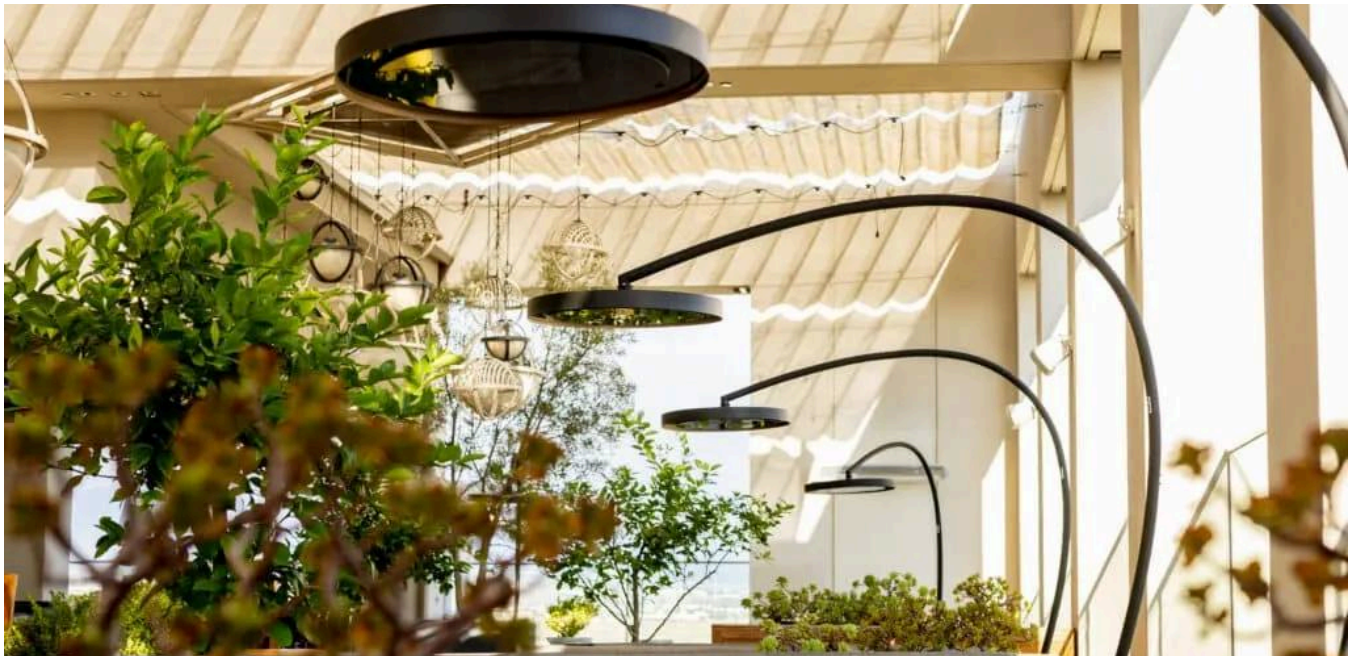


EDITION
October 2026

BROMIC HEATING
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For architects, builders and homeowners.

The shift



The patio is now a room for all year. Cold after dark empties it, and heating is planned last.

01 Outdoor living is the heart of the home



55%

net share of architects see outdoor living spaces rising in popularity.[1]
AIA, Home Design Trends Survey, Q2 2025

- Families gather and dine outside.
- Covered patios are planned as rooms.
- Comfort decides use.

Bromic insight Radiant heat makes the patio part of the house after sunset.

Design move Draw the patio as a room, with heat and power.

02 Outdoor space is used morning to night



67%

say heating would do most to extend their outdoor time.[2]
Atomik Research for Bromic Heating, 2025

- Coffee at dawn, dinner at dusk.
- Cold cuts both short.
- Those are the hours people want most.

Bromic insight Radiant heat adds comfortable hours. Extend the moment.

Design move Zone heat by time of day.

03 Patios are core infrastructure



60.5%

of new single-family homes started in 2025 came with a patio.[4]
NAHB, from Census Survey of Construction, 2025

- Patios are built in, not added on.
- Services are planned in.
- A daily-use patio earns its place.

Bromic insight Heating turns an occasional patio into an everyday room.

Design move Rough in heater circuits or gas at framing.

04 Renovation spending holds steady



$525B

projected yearly US homeowner spending on improvements and repairs, through Q3 2027.[5]

Harvard Joint Center for Housing Studies, LIRA, Oct 2026

- Owners improve rather than move.
- Upgrades center on outdoor living.
- Many recover most of their cost at resale.

Bromic insight A small addition that changes how often a space is used.

Design move Budget heating with the pergola and lighting.

05 Indoor and outdoor are one space



40%

net share of architects see blended indoor-outdoor spaces rising in popularity.[1]
AIA, Home Design Trends Survey, Q2 2025

- Glass walls retract.
- Floors and ceilings run straight through.
- The terrace belongs to the living plan.

Bromic insight Radiant heat warms people, not air, so it works with the walls open.

Design move Carry the ceiling outside; recess the heaters.

06 Pergolas define outdoor rooms



33%

of homeowners upgrading outdoors do it to extend their living space.[6]
Houzz, U.S. Outdoor Trends Study, 2024

- Pergolas mark out zones.
- They are designed in.
- They carry light, sound and heat.

Bromic insight Pergolas make ideal mounts for integrated radiant heat.

Design move Wire pergolas for heaters, Affinity controls and wall switch.

07 Smart outdoor living is becoming standard



5

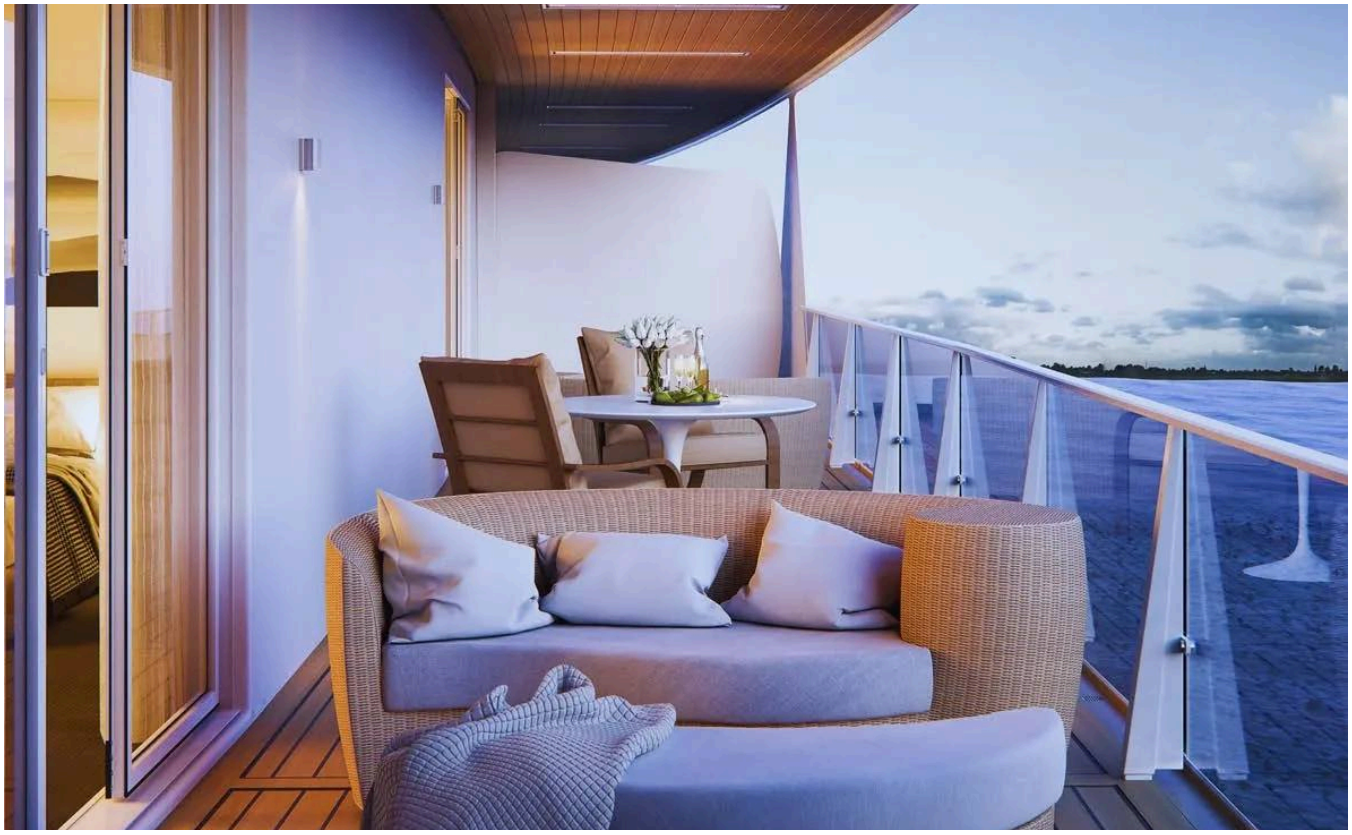
smart-home platforms work with Affinity Smart-Heat Controls.[8]
Bromic Lookbook 2026; compatibility varies

- One platform for light, heat and sound.
- App control is expected.
- Rooms respond to the hour.

Bromic insight Affinity controls link heaters to the Smart-Heat app and voice assistants. Wi-Fi and app features need compatible Affinity controls, sold separately.

Design move Specify each heater with its controller, wall switch and app.

08 Design-led products replace utility products



9.9

out of 10: homeowners' Joy Score for a new patio.[7]
NAR and NALP, Remodeling Impact Report, 2023

- Looks matter as much as function.
- Flush fittings replace visible hardware.
- Space reads as one with the house.

Bromic insight Recessed heaters vanish. Heat you can feel, not see.

Design move Detail recess kits, controller and wall switch early.

09 Small spaces, full use



121 ft²

approx. heated by one Eclipse Smart-Heat Freestanding heater.[8]
Bromic Lookbook 2026

- Smaller lots need zoning.
- One footprint, several uses.
- No clutter.

Bromic insight Radiant heat targets people, not air, so it suits compact spaces.

Design move Heat each zone, on its Eclipse controller and the app.

10 Heating moves from add-on to built-in



23%

of homeowners rank outdoor heating a top planning priority.[3]
Atomik Research for Bromic Heating, 2025

- Grills went built-in. Heating is next.
- It is specified with lighting.
- Built-in heat means reliable use.

Bromic insight Design-led heat is integrated from the beginning.

Design move Put heaters, circuits and controls on the first drawings.

Plan from the start



Year-round use begins at the architectural stage. Added later, power, mounting and controls become constraints.

Every Bromic heater needs an Affinity On/Off, Dimmer or Eclipse controller, a wall switch and the Smart-Heat app. Wi-Fi and app features need compatible Affinity controls, sold separately.

Designed from the start, not added later.

Sources and method



STAT	SOURCE
55%, 40%	AIA, Home Design Trends Survey, Q2 2025[1]
67%, 23%	Atomik Research for Bromic Heating, 2025[2][3]
60.5%	NAHB, Census Survey of Construction, 2025[4]
$525B	Harvard JCHS, LIRA, Oct 2026[5]
33%	Houzz, U.S. Outdoor Trends Study, 2024[6]
9.9	NAR and NALP, Remodeling Impact Report, 2023[7]
5, 121 ft²	Bromic Lookbook 2026[8]

AIA figures are net (rising minus falling). Bromic commissioned the Atomik homeowner survey.

NEXT STEP

Size your space



Sources

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2. **Bromic Heating (feature release, syndicated)**, An overlooked detail that can make or break your outdoor space (Atomik Research survey for Bromic) (2026). https://www.crimson.fit.edu/online_features/home_decorating/an-overlooked-detail-that-can-make-or-break-your-outdoor-space/article_5a94e098-a466-5cc9-8e1e-360becfd14d1.html
3. **Bromic Heating (press release, syndicated)**, Americans crave more time outdoors at home, but their homes aren't built for it (Atomik Research survey for Bromic) (2026). https://business.mammothtimes.com/mammothtimes/article/gnwcq-2026-2-4-americans-crave-more-time-outdoors-at-home-but-their-homes-arent-built-for-it
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6. **Houzz**, 10 Outdoor Renovation Trends Everyone Should Know About (2024 U.S. Houzz Outdoor Trends Study) (2024). https://www.houzz.com/magazine/10-outdoor-renovation-trends-everyone-should-know-about-stsetivw-vs~176358500
7. **National Association of Realtors and National Association of Landscape Professionals**, 2023 Remodeling Impact Report: Outdoor Features (2023). https://www.nar.realtor/research-and-statistics/research-reports/remodeling-impact-report-outdoor-features
8. **Bromic Heating**, Lookbook 2026 (2026)

Confirm every installation with your local building authority and a licensed electrician or gas fitter. Wi-Fi and app features need compatible Affinity Smart-Heat controls, sold separately. © 2026 Bromic Heating · bromic.com